AA-B-260F
July 30, 1975
SUPERSEDING
Fed. Spec. AA-B-260E
August 27, 1971

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

BEDSPRING, BOX TYPE

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers box-type bedsprings with coil construction.

1.2 Classification.

1.2.1 Box-type bedsprings shall be of the following finished sizes, as specified (see 6.2).

1 - (Single type) 38 by 75 inches
2 - (Double type) 53 by 75 inches
3 - (Single type, special) 36-1/2 by 79-1/2 inches
4 - (Single, oversize) 38 by 80 inches
5 - (Double, oversize) 53 by 80 inches (see 6.5)
6 - (Queen) 60 by 80 inches (see 6.5)

NOTE: The above measurements apply to the top surface of the bedsprings. The above sizes are subject to allowable tolerances of plus or minus 1/2 inch.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents, of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein:

Federal Specifications:

V-T-276 - Thread, Cotton
V-T-285 - Thread, Polyester

FSC 7210

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CCC-C-430 - Cloth, Sheeting, Cotton, and Polyester and Cotton
CCC-C-432 - Cloth, Sheeting, Cotton, (Unbleached, Bleached, and Dyed)
CCC-C-436 - Cloth, Ticking Twill, Cotton
PPP-B-636 - Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard
PPP-B-640 - Boxes, Fiberboard, Corrugated, Triple-Wall
PPP-T-45 - Tape, Gummed, Paper, Reinforced and Plain, for Sealing and Securing

Federal Standards:

FED-STD-123 - Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civil Agencies)
FED-STD-191 - Textile Test Methods
FED-STD-751 - Stitches, Seams, and Stitchings

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other Federal specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge from Business Service Centers at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, DC, Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, MO, Fort Worth, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, WA.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies).

Military Specifications:

MIL-P-116 - Preservation, Packaging, Methods of
MIL-B-121 - Barrier Material, Greaseproofed, Waterproofed, Flexible

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage
MIL-STD-147 - Palletized Unit Loads for 40" x 48" Pallets
MIL-STD-1363 - Measurement of Wood Moisture Content

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(Copies of specifications, standards, drawings, and publications required by suppliers in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer).

Laws and Regulations:

C&MS-SRA-180 Cotton and Cotton Linters Standards

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Superintendent of Documents, US Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402).

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless a specific issue is identified, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply:

National Motor Freight Traffic Association, Inc., Agent

National Motor Freight Classification

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Trucking Associations, Inc., Tariff Order Section, 1616 P Street, N.W., Washington, DC 20036).

Uniform Classification Committee, Agent

Uniform Freight Classification

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Uniform Classification Committee, Room 1106, 222 South Riverside Plaza, Chicago, IL 60606).

American Society for Testing and Materials

D-2555 - Standard Methods for Establishing Clear Wood Strength Values

(Application for copies should be addressed to American Society for Testing and Materials, 1916 Race Street, Philadelphia, PA 19103).

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 First article. When specified (see 6.2), the supplier shall furnish a sample for first article inspection and approval (see 4.3 and 6.4).

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3.2 Materials and components. The materials specified shall conform to the applicable specifications and requirements specified hereinafter. When materials are not definitely specified, they shall be of the quality normally used in industry practice provided the completed item complies with all the provisions of this specification.

3.2.1 Wood. Wood used in the fabrication of the frame shall have a moisture content of no more than 15 percent kiln dried, when tested as specified in 4.4.11.1. Wood pieces shall be free of splits, cross grain exceeding one inch in 10 inches or knots larger than 1/4 width of board, decay, shakes, loose knots or honey combing. Wood for filler sticks may have knots 1/2 the width of the board. The wood shall be any wood listed in ASTM D-2555 having the following characteristics:

Modulus of rupture	4850 to 8700	pound per square inch (psi)
Modulus of elasticity	1000 to 1600	thousands of pounds per square inch (ksi)
Compression		
Parallel to grain	2200 to 4300	psi
Perpendicular to grain	195 to 530	psi
Sheer strength	600 to 1050	psi

3.2.2 Wire. Wire gages and tensile strengths may be accepted on the supplier's certificate of compliance (see 4.1.1).

3.2.2.1 Spring coil wire. Wire for spring coils shall be a high carbon steel upholstery round spring wire, having knotting, and coiling quality. The wire shall be 10-1/2 or 10 gage, and shall have a tensile strength range of 182.5 to 225 ksi.

3.2.2.2 Border wire. Border wire shall be round, not less than 6-1/2 gage, high carbon steel, and shall have a tensile strength range of 157.5 to 187 ksi.

3.2.2.3 Insulator wire. Wire for the insulator shall be round, not less than 19 gage oil-tempered steel, and shall have a tensile strength range of 266 to 296 ksi.

3.2.3 Felt. The felt shall be clean, having unbroken laminated sheets of a well-garnetted blend of not less than 25 percent cotton and not more than 75 percent linters.

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3.2.3.1 Cotton. The cotton shall be new (not previously used), of minimum 7/8 inch staple, and not lower than United States Grade Low Middling Spotted grade, conforming to the standards of United States Department of Agriculture Publication C&MS-SRA-180.

3.2.3.2 Linters. The linters shall be new (not previously used) and not lower than United States standard grade 3, staple 3 conforming to United States Department of Agriculture Publication C&MS-SRA-180.

3.2.4 Ticking. Ticking used for the cover to encase the bedspring shall conform to type I or II, class 1 or class 2 of CCC-C-436.

3.2.5 Sheeting and nonwoven fabric. The sheeting for the dust cover shall be cotton conforming to type VII or VIII, class 1 of CCC-C-432, or type I, class 1, style A of CCC-C-430, or a spun, bonded nylon, polyester or polypropolene, non-woven fabric having a weight of 1-1/2 to 3-1/2 ounces per square yard, when tested as specified in 4.4.1.1.

3.2.6 Thread cotton or thread polyester. The thread shall be cotton, type IA1 or IA2, ticket No. 30, 3 ply of V-T-276 or polyester, type I, class I, subclass A, size E of V-T-285.

3.2.7 Tape. The tape used in finishing the top edges of the boxspring cover (see 3.3.3), shall be cotton, 5/8 inch minimum width and shall have a minimum breaking strength of 30 pounds, or shall be a polyester tape, 5/8 inch minimum width with a minimum breaking strength of 100 pounds, when tested in accordance with 4.4.1.1.

3.2.8 Tacks and staples. Tacks and staples shall be upholsterer's commercial hand or power driven type and shall be blued steel, copper-lacquer or other corrosion resisting coated steel. Tacks and staples for attachment of dust cover and ticking shall be not less than a 3 ounce size with minimum 3/8 inch long legs. Tacks and staples for attachment of lifting straps shall be not less than a 12 ounce size with minimum 11/16 inch long legs. Blued steel plaster board nails for attaching the lifting straps are acceptable.

3.3 Details of components.

3.3.1 Spring coils. Spring coils shall be fabricated from material conforming to 3.2.2.1. Coils shall be formed into a cone shape with approximately 6-1/2 convolutions, to a free height of 6 $\pm$ 1/4 inch. The bottom convolution shall be free and the top convolution shall be knotted to prevent protrusion through the pad or insulator. The coils shall be tempered after forming in accordance with manufacturer's standard practice. The coils shall not decrease more than 3/16 inch in height, when tested as specified in 4.4.1.1.

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3.3.2 Insulator, wire mat. The wire mat insulator shall consist of steel wires conforming to 3.2.2.3 and fiber cords. The fiber cords shall bee spirally wound from not less than 30 pound kraft paper. The wire mat shall have a series of steel wires uniformly spaced linch ± 3/8 inch apart, running at right angles to the longitudinal fiber cords uniformly spaced not more than 8 inches apart. The wire shall pierce and pass through the center cords and shall be crimped around the border cords. The center cords shall be not less than 0.16 inch in diameter with or without a core and shall have a minimum breaking strength of 100 pounds when tested as specified in 4.4.2.3. The border cords shall be not less than 0.125 inch in diameter with a minimum breaking strength of 100 pounds when tested as specified in 4.4.1.1. At the option of the manufacturer, the border cord may have a polypropylene core. The dimensions of the wire mat shall be 3 inches ± 1/4 inch less in length and 2 inches ± 1/4 inch less in width than the applicable spring unit.

3.3.3 Cover (ticking). The bedspring cover shall be fabricated from ticking, thread, and tape, conforming to 3.2.4, 3.2.6, and 3.2.7, respectively. The top section of the cover shall be made of not more than two pieces of ticking securely sewed together (see 3.3.3.2) with the seam running lengthwise of the cover. The stripes of the ticking shall also run lengthwise of the cover and shall be matched when two pieces are used. The border shall be made of not more than two pieces of ticking with ends securely sewed together except that stitching at the end of the tape shall overlap at least 1 inch. The top of the cover shall be sewed to the border with the tape folded over the seam to give a neatly finished edge. Not more than three pieces of tape shall be used on any one cover. All stitching on the cover shall conform to 3.3.3.1.

3.3.3.1 Stitching All stitching shall be machine stitching conforming to stitch type 301 or 401 of FED-STD-751 with 8 to 12 stitches per inch.

3.3.3.2 Seams. When lengthwise pieces of ticking are used (see 3.3.3) they shall be stitched with stitch type 401 and seamed with seam type LSb-2, or stitch type 301 and seam type SSa-1 conforming to FED-STD-751.

3.3 3.3 Thread breaks and ends of seams. Ends of all seams and stitching produced with 301 stitch type when not caught in other seams or stitchings shall be backtacked not less ther 1/4 inch. Thread breaks (all stitch types) shall be secured by stitching back of the break not less than 1 inch. Skipped stitches or thread breaks (401 stitch type) shall be repaired using 301 stitch type.

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3.3.4 Lifting straps. Straps shall be fabricated from two thicknesses of ticking conforming to 3.2.4. Each strap shall have an exposed loop 4-1/4 to 4-3/4 inches long, and 1-1/2 to 2 inches in width. The two thicknesses of ticking shall be sewn together without evidence of raw edges. The stitching shall conform to 3.3.3.1. At the option of the supplier, cord, braided cotton coil, or plastic may be used for the lifting straps.

3.4 Construction.

3.4.1 Frame, wood. The frame shall be constructed of wood conforming to 3.2.1. The frame shall conform to the design, details, and dimensions of figure 1, except that when the bedspring is intended for use with foam-rubber mattress (see 6.2), it shall be built up to a depth of 3-7/16 ± 1/4 inch by the addition of extra side and end rails to the underside of the frame. Wood shall be dressed on the two board sides and the outside edges of the finished frame. All edges of the wood shall be rounded or softened where friction of cloth and wood could take place. The frame shall be assembled with nails of a sufficient length to permit clinching. Nailing not staggered and hairline cracks due to nailing are acceptable. The protruding nails shall be clinched and flattened so that all surfaces of the frame shall be smooth. Power-driven nails designed or coated to resist pull-out shall be acceptable without requiring clinching providing that the nails are of sufficient length to penetrate a minimum of 95 percent of the pieces being nailed.

3.4.2 Spring unit. The spring units shall be either cross-helically laced spring or grid top construction. Spring units shall have the following number of coil springs, as applicable:

	Cross-helical and laced	Grid top
Size 1	60	54
Size 2	80	81
Size 3	66	60
Size 4	66	60
Size 5	88	90
Size 6	88	100

3.4.2.1 Cross-helical spring-unit construction. The cross helical spring unit shall be constructed with coils conforming to 3.3.1. The coils shall be assembled to steel base wires not less than 11-1/2 gage (see 4.4.1). The base wires shall be parallel to the sides and ends of the unit and cross directly over and under the lower convolution of each coil spring.

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The top base wire shall pass under the lower convolution and the bottom base wire shall pass over it. The coils shall be locked in place by crimping the base wire at intersections. The tops of the coils shall be joined together using cross helicals made of wire not less than 16-1/2 gage, high-carbon, upholstery grade spring steel wire (see 4.1.1). The helicals shall be securely attached to four equally spaced positions of each coil spring except for border coils. The border coils shall have two helicals attached (corner coils require only one helical). Each border coil shall be attached to a border fabricated from wire conforming to 3.2.2.2 with commercial metal clips not less than 1 inch long, except when automatic clipping is performed (see 3.4.2.3). Ends of the border shall be joined either by butt welding or by the use of a 20 gage tube not less than 2 inches long securely crimped in place. The ends and sides of the unit shall be braced with wires of not less than 9-1/2 gage, high-carbon, upholstery grade, spring steel wire. There shall be not less than two brace wires parallel to the sides and not less than three parallel to the ends. The brace wires shall be located at equal distances between the sides and ends and tangent to rows of coil springs. The brace shall be secured to the border with metal clips not less than 1 inch long, except when automatic clipping is performed (see 3.4.2.3) or looped around the border and securely crimped. The brace wires shall be secured to each coil spring in the row next to the coil by metal clips not less than 1 inch long.

3.4.2.2 Laced spring-unit construction. The laced spring unit construction shall conform to 3.4.2.1 except that the securing of the tops of the coils to each other and to the border wires shall conform to any of the following methods:

(a) The tops of the coils shall be connected together with crimp-quality lacing steel wire of not less than 14-1/2 gage (see 4.1.1). There shall be two lacing wires extending the full width and two lacing wires extending the full length of the unit for each row of coils, except border coils where one lacing wire only is required. The ends of the lacings shall be securely fastened to the border wire. The lacing wires shall pass over four sides at top of each coil, except at the border, and shall be secured to the coils by short lacing wires which connect coils together on four sides, except at the border. The short lacing wires shall pass under the top convolution of the coils and shall be crimped over the lacing wires running the length and width of the unit. Each border coil shall be secured to the border wire with metal clips not less than 1 inch long, except when automatic clipping is performed (see 3.4.2.3), or with helicals constructed of high carbon steel wire of not less than 17 gage. The ends of the helicals, when used, shall be turned in to form a smooth, rounded termination.

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(b) The tops of the coils shall be connected together by the use of crimp-quality lacing wire of not less than 14-1/2 gage (see 4.1.1). There shall be two lacing wires extending the full length of the unit for each row of coils, except border rows where one lacing wire on each border will be required, and one lacing wire extending the full width of the unit for each row of coils. The longitudinal lacing wires shall be formed to produce suitable offsets throughout the length and centered on transverse coil rows. These offsets shall include a tipped loop at the apex which shall serve as the anchorage for the transverse lacing wires. The offsets of longitudinal lacing wires shall pass beneath the top convolution of adjacent coils, and the transverse lacing wires shall pass over the top convolution at the center of coils and through the tipped loops to lock the coils into position. All border coils shall be secured to the border wire by wrapping and clinching the lacing wire to the border wire.

(c) The coils shall be connected as specified in (b), except spring-steel clips shall be used in place of the longitudinal lacing wires. Offsets shall be formed on transverse lacing wires to receive the spring clips. The clips shall be tempered steel not less than 0.030 inch thick and 5/16 inch wide. Adjacent coils in transverse rows shall be connected with the ends of the clips looped around the formed offsets in the transverse wires and back over the top convolution of the coils. The ends of all lacing wires and clips shall be turned down to prevent the padding from becoming pierced when it is placed on the unit. The lacing wires are not required to be attached to the border wires. All border coils shall be secured to the border wire with helicals of high-carbon steel wire of not less than 17 gage or with metal clips not less than 1 inch long except when automatic clipping is performed (see 3.4.2.3). The ends of helicals, when used, shall be turned in so as to form a smooth, rounded termination.

3.4.2.3 Automatic clipping. When automatic clipping machines are used, the coils shall be secured to the border with metal clips not less than 1/2 inch long.

3.4.2.4 Grid top construction. The grid top spring unit shall be formed by attaching coils fabricated of the wire specified in 3.2.2.1 to a grid. The grid shall be formed by attaching top wires to an angle border wire in accordance with commercial practice. The top wires shall be 13-1/2 gage minimum, having a tensile strength between 125 ksi and 155 ksi. The border wire shall be 6 gage minimum, having a tensile strength between 80 ksi and 110 ksi (see 4.1.1).

3.4.3 Attachment of spring unit to frame. The spring unit shall be securely stapled to the wood frame in accordance with industry practice.

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3.4.4 Fastening of insulator. The spring unit shall be covered with a wire-mat insulator conforming to 3.3.2. The insulator shall be securely fastened to the unit by three commercial hog rings attached on each longitudinal side. Two of the rings shall be near the ends. Rings shall not be clamped around the fiber cord on the edge of the mat, but shall be clamped around one wire of the mat and the top of a border coil.

3.4.5 Felt covering. The attached insulator shall be covered with felt conforming to 3.2.3. The felt shall be in full-length and full-width layers, evenly distributed. The size 1 bedspring shall contain not less than 7 pounds of felt; the size 2 bedspring shall contain not less than 10 pounds of felt; size 3 and 4 bedsprings shall contain not less than 8 pounds of felt; size 5 bedspring shall contain not less than 11 pounds of felt, and the size 6 bedspring shall contain not less than 13 pounds of felt. Corners shall be well padded with felt before the ticking is applied.

3.4.6 Installation of cover (ticking). The cover specified in 3.3.3 shall be placed over the unit and pulled down over the sides forming a border of uniform width. The cover shall be securely attached to the bottom of the wood frame with tacks or staples conforming to 3.2.8, on approximately 2 inch centers.

3.4.7 Attachment of lifting straps. Before attachment of bottom dust cover, the bedspring shall have four lifting straps conforming to 3.3.4, attached with tacks or staples conforming to 3.2.8. Two straps shall be attached to the bottom of the wood frame on each of the two longitudinal sides. Each strap shall be one-third the distance from each end of the unit.

3.4.8 Bottom dust cover. The bottom of the bedspring shall be covered with sheeting or nonwoven fabric conforming to 3.2.5, and shall be made of not more than two pieces of sheeting or nonwoven fabric. All edges of the sheeting shall be turned under a minimum of 1/4 inch and fastened to the wood frame with tacks or staples, conforming to 3.2.8, on approximately 2 inch centers. The fastened dust cover shall be free of wrinkles The edges of the nonwoven fabric need not be turned under.

3.4.9 Finish on spring unit and mounting plates. The fabricated spring units specified in 3.4.2, except grid top construction, and the mounting plates specified in 3.5, shall be completely coated with baked-on enamel, or aluminum or rust resisting metal paint in accordance with commercial practice. The unit shall be free of grease, oil, dirt, and loose scale prior to enameling or painting. Any color of coating is acceptable. Enamel finish may be from dull to high gloss. The coating on a spring unit shall be thoroughly adherent and free of blisters and areas of no coating.

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3.4.10 Labels. Labels required by state laws shall be marked to conform to the legal requirements of the state in which the bedsprings are manufactured and shall be sewed to each bedspring at either end or tacked on at each of the four corners of the label on the box spring end rail. When specified (see 6.2), an additional label shall bear information specifically designated by the procuring agency.

3.5 Legs. When specified (see 6.2), six round tapered wooden legs shall be furnished with each bedspring, complete with mounting bracket plate, and wood screws, the legs shall be 7 inches long overall and made of kiln dried Beech, Birch, or Maple. The wood shall be straight grained, and shall be free of any knots and decay. The taper design shall have a minimum top diameter of 1-3/4 inches and a minimum bottom diameter of 3/4 inch. Inserted in the top of the leg there shall be a 5/16 inch diameter stud bolt for attachment to the mounting plate. The threaded end of the bolt shall have a No. 18-NC threaded portion which protrudes a maximum 5/16 inch beyond the leg top for threading into the mounting plate. The bottom of the leg shall be fitted with a brass ferrule having a self-adjusting, 1-1/8 inch diameter nylon glide. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2), legs shall be given a blonde finish in accordance with manufacturers standard practice. The mounting bracket plate shall be 2-1/2 inches wide by 3-1/4 inches $\pm$ 1/4 inch and shall be a minimum 16 gage steel (see 4.1.1). The mounting bracket plate shall have a 5/16 inch No. 18-NC threaded hole in the center for attaching the leg stud bolt and a minimum of 4 holes for attaching the plate to the bottom frame of the box spring. The necessary number of wood screws shall be provided. The mounting plates shall be finished as specfied in 3.4.9.

3.6 Workmanship. Cloth components shall be clean and free of holes, cuts, tears, or cloth defects such as smashes, weak places, or broken or missing yarns covering around the corners of the spring unit, with no more than 2 pleats is acceptable. Tape shall not have frayed or scalloped edges and shall be free of cuts or abrasions. Thread tension shall be maintained so that there will be no loose stitching. Seam allowances shall be maintained with seams properly sewed so that no runoffs, twists, pleats, puckers, or seams shall result. All thread ends shall be trimmed. Metal components shall be free of burrs, sharp edges, corroded areas and shall not be broken or malformed.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or order, the supplier may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government.

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The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Certificates of compliance. When certificates of compliance are submitted, the Government reserves the right to check test such items to determine the validity of certification (see 3.2, 3.4.2.1, 3.4.2.2, 3.4.2.4 and 3.5).

4.2 Classification of inspection. The inspection requirements specified herein are classified as follows:

1. First article inspection (see 4.3)
2. Quality conformance inspection (see 4.4)

4.3 First article. When a first article is required, the box type bedspring shall be examined as specified in 4.4.4.1 and 4.4.4.2. Any nonconformance shall be cause for rejection of the first article.

4.4 Quality conformance inspection. Except as otherwise specified herein, sampling for inspection shall be performed in accordance with the provisions set forth in MIL-STD-105.

4.4.1 Component and material inspection. In accordance with 4.1 above, components and materials shall be tested in accordance with all the requirements of referenced specifications, drawings and standards unless otherwise excluded, amended, modified or qualified in this specification or applicable purchase document.

4.4.1.1 Testing of components. In addition to the quality assurance provisions of the referenced specifications, components and materials listed in table II shall be tested for the characteristics shown therein. The methods of testing specified in FED-STD-191, wherever applicable, and as specified herein shall be followed. When the data in the "Number of determinations per sample unit" and the "Results reported as" columns are not specified in table II, they shall be as required in the referenced test method. All test reports shall contain the individual values utilized in expressing the final result. The sample size shall be in accordance with table I and the lot shall be unacceptable if the lot average of one or more units fail to meet any requirement specified.

TABLE I. Sampling for testing

Lot size	Sample size
800 or less	2
801 up to and including 22,000	3
22,001 and over	5

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TABLE II. Test methods of components

Component and lot expressed in terms of	Characteristic	Requirement paragraph	Test method	Requirement applicable to: Sample unit	Requirement applicable to: Lot average	Number determinations per sample unit	Results reported as	Sample unit
Cotton (1 bale)	Staple length	3.2.3.1	Visual 1/	-	X	1	Pass or fail	1/2 pound
	Grade	3.2.3.1	Visual 1/	-	X	1	Pass or fail	1/2 pound
Linters (1 bale)	Grade and staple	3.2.3.2	Visual 1/	-	X	1	Pass or fail	1/2 pound
Garnetted felt (100 lbs)	Quality and composition	3.2.3	Visual	-	X	1	Pass or fail	12 inches by 12 inches
			1/ 4/	-	X	1		
Edge binding (1 spool)	Material identification	3.2.7	Standard commercial	X	-	1	Pass or fail	
	Breaking strength	3.2.7	4102 2/ 3/	X	-	-	-	1 cone or spool
	Width	3.2.7	Rule	-	X	3	Pass or fail	
Nonwoven fabric	Material identification	3.2.5	4/					
	Weight per square yard	3.2.5	5041 2/	X	-	1	Pass or fail	Square yard

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TABLE II. Test methods of components

Component and lot expressed in terms of	Characteristic	Requirement paragraph	Test method	Requirement applicable to: Sample unit	Requirement applicable to: Lot average	Number determinations per sample unit	Results reported as	Sample unit
Wood pieces	Moisture content	3.2.1	MIL-STD-1363	X	-	3	Pass or fail	1 piece of wood of sufficient quantity to perform test
Center cord	Breaking strength	3.3.2	4102 2/	X	-	1	Pass or fail	3 two yard lengths of unpierced center cord
Border cord	Breaking strength	3.3.2	4102 2/	X	-	1	Pass or fail	3 two yard lengths of unpierced border cord
Spring coil	Compression	3.3.1	4.5.1	X	-	1	Pass or fail	2 coils

1/ Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2, the cotton or linters or felt shall be examined to determine conformance with 3.2 3, 3.2.3.1 and 3.7.3.2, inclusive, by classifiers licensed by the U.S. Department of Agriculture; or representative samples, each weighing not less than 1/2 pound, of the cotton or linters and a minimum 12 inches by 12 inches of felt shall be forwarded to the administrative office concerned at Memphis, TN 38103, where inspection by the proper board of the U.S. Department of Agriculture shall be obtained. The opinion of this board as to the true grade or quality will be final. Inspection reports from the U.S.D.A. shall be furnished and will be acceptable for the stated requirements.

2/ See FED-STD-191.

3/ Except that the full width of the tape shall be used.

4/ A supplier's certificate of compliance shall be furnished and will be acceptable for the stated requirements.

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4.4.2 Intermediate inspection. Intermediate inspection shall be performed on the wood frame assembly and the spring units prior to fabrication. Inspection shall also be performed on the wire mat insulator. The defects found during examination shall be in accordance with 4.4.2.1, 4.4.2.2 and 4.4.2.3. The inspection levels and AQLs expressed in defects per 100 units shall be as follows:

For examination in	Inspection level	AQLs
4.4.2.1	S-2	One class 6.5
4.4.2.2	S-2	One class 6.5
4.4.2.3	S-2	One class 6.5

4.4.2.1 Examination of wood frame assembly for visual defects. The sample unit for this examination shall be one completely fabricated wood frame. Examination of the wood frame assembly for defects in material and workmanship shall be as follows:

Examine	Defect
Wood (general)	Not smooth Lumber piece under size specified Split or cross grain exceeding one inch in 10 inches Not dressed on two board sides Loose knots, decay, shake, or honeycombing effecting holding power of nails Knot larger than 1/4 width of board (unless otherwise permitted) Outside frame edges not dressed
Frame (assembly)	Not assembled as specified Nails not clinched and flattened (more than 10) Corner radius not as specified Edges not rounded or softened Dimensions not as specified including permitted tolerances

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4.4.2.2 Examination of spring unit for visual defects. The sample unit for this examination shall be one spring unit ready to be assembled to wood frame. Examination of the spring unit for defects in material and workmanship shall be as follows:

Examine	Defect
Spring unit (cross helical spring construction)	Base wires not parallel to sides or ends, or do not cross directly over and under the lower convolution of each coil spring Helical not securely attached to coil spring Border coil not attached to border wire with metal clips Border ends not joined by butt weld or 2 inch crimped tube Braced with less than 3 wires parallel to each end or with less than 2 wires parallel at each side Brace wires not located as near as possible at equal distances between the sides and ends and tangent to rows of coil springs Braces not secured to border with metal clips or looped around border and securely crimped Brace wires not secured to each coil spring by metal clips
Spring unit (laced spring construction)	Base wires not parallel to sides or ends, or do not cross directly over and under the lower convolution of each coil spring Tops of coils not joined togetner with crimp quality lacing wire or spring steel clips Less than two lacing wires extending full length or width of unit as applicable, for each row of coils, except border coils Lacing wire not securely attached to border Lacing wire not placed over or on coils as specified Border coils not secured to border with metal clips or helicals or by wrapping and clinching

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Examine	Defect
Spring unit (grid top construction)	Not designed as specified Coils not attached to a grid Grid not attached to border wire Border wire more than one piece
Spring unit (finish)	Not coated as specified; coating not thoroughly adherant and free from blisters or areas of no coating Number of coils less than specified

4.4.2.3 Examination of wire mat. The sample unit for this examination shall be one completely fabricated wire mat. Defects shall be as listed below:

Examine	Defect
Dimensions (length and width)	Not as specified
Spacing of steel wires	Not as specified
Spacing of fiber cords	Not as specified

4.4.3 In-process inspection. Inspection shall be made at any point or during any phase of the manufacturing process to determine whether operations or assemblies are accomplished as specified. The Government reserves the right to exclude from consideration for acceptance any material or service for which in-process inspection has indicated non-conformance. In-process inspection shall be made to determine compliance with the following. Correction shall be made to noncomplying items and the process shall be corrected.

Operation or assembly	Requirement paragraph
Application of spring unit to wood frame	3.4.3
Application of insulator (wire mat) to spring unit	3.4.4
Application of felt to spring unit assembly	3.4.5
Construction of cover and border	3.3.3
Application of fabricated cover to bedspring assembly	3.4.6
Application of lifting handles to bedspring assembly	3.4.7
Application of dust cover to bedspring assembly	3.4.8

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4.4.4 Inspection of the end item. The lot shall be the number of bedsprings offered for inspection. The sample unit shall be one completely fabricated bedspring.

4.4.4.1 Visual examination. Examination of the bedsprings shall be in accordance with the defects in table IV. The inspection level shall be level II with an AQL of 2.5 for major defects and 10.0 for total defects, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units.

TABLE IV. Classification of end item defects

Examine	Defects	Classification Major	Minor
Ticking	Top section of cover made of more than two pieces		X
	Hole, cut, tear, smash, mend or open place:		
	- Up to 1 inch, inclusive		X
	- More than 1 inch	X	
	Loose yarn, snagged thread, misweave, missing yarn, broken yarn, thin place, shade bar, or woven in waste:		
	- Up to 1 inch, inclusive		X
	- More than 1 inch	X	
	Rancid or other objectionable odor	X	
	Not fabric specified	X	
	Start marks (heavy or light)		X
	Spot or stain 1/4 inch or over in diameter, clearly noticeable when viewed at a distance within 3 feet		X
	Excessive neppiness	X	
	Seam running widthwise	X	
	Stripes not lengthwise		X
	Stripes not matched (two piece construction)		X

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TABLE IV. Classification of end item defects (cont'd)

Examine	Defects	Classification Major	Minor
Tape (binding)	More than three pieces of tape used on one cover		X
Seams and stitching	Any required seam or stitching operation omitted	X	
	Ticking not seamed with seam type SSa-1 or LSb-2		X
	Less than 8 or more than 12 stitches per inch		X
	Ends of any seam (when not caught in other seams or stitchings) backtacked or backstitched less than 1/4 inch		X
	Thread breaks (all stitch types) stitched less than 1 inch beyond each end of break		X
	Open seam more than 1 inch in length	X	
	Open seam 1 inch or less in length		X
	Raw edge more than 1 inch in length		X
	NOTE: A seam shall be classified as open when one or more stitches are broken or when two or more continuous skipped stitches or run-offs occur.		
	Stitch tension loose, resulting in a loosely secured seam		X
	Stitch tension tight (stitches break when normal strain is applied to the seam or stitching)		X
	NOTE: Puckering is evidence of tight tension, when puckering is evident, the inspector shall test seams by exerting pull on seam.		
	Needle chew, nole or cut	X	
	Seam badly puckered, pleated, twisted or caught in unrelated operation		X
	Untrimmed thread ends throughout		X

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TABLE IV. Classification of end item defects (cont'd)

Examine	Defects	Classification Major	Minor
Construction and workmanship	Poorly tailored (including more than 2 pleats per item)		X
	Dirty		X
	Border not uniform		X
Lifting straps	Strap missing or not located as specified	X	
	Not fabricated of two thicknesses of ticking		X
	Less than 8 or more than 12 stitches per inch		X
	Raw edge showing		X
Bottom dust cover	Wrinkled		X
	Constructed of more than two pieces		X
	Edges of sheeting not turned under a minimum of 1/4 inch		X
	Not securely attached to frame with tacks or staples		X
	Hole, smash, part, tear, mend or open place:		
	- Up to 1 inch, inclusive		X
	- More than 1 inch	X	
Labels	Missing, incomplete, incorrect or illegible		X
Legs (when applicable)	Not six in number	X	
	Not furnished complete with mounting bracket plate and wood screws required	X	
	Not round and tapered	X	
	Not made of wood specified	X	
	Wood not straight grained		X
	Wood contains knots or decay	X	
	Stud bolt missing	X	
	Stud bolt not threaded as specified		X

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TABLE IV. Classification of end item defects (cont'd)

Examine	Defects	Classification Major	Minor
Legs (when applicable) (cont'd)	Stud bolt protrudes more than 5/16 inch beyond leg top		X
	Metal ferrule missing	X	
	Glide missing	X	
	Glide not as specified		X
	Finish not in accordance with manufacturer's standard practice		X
Mounting bracket plate	Not tapped as specified		X
	Not coated as specified; coating not thoroughly adherent and free from blisters or areas of no coating		X

4.4.4.2 Dimensional examination. Inspection shall be made of the bedspring for defects in dimensions. Any dimension that is not within specified tolerances shall be classified as a defect. The inspection level shall be level S-3 with an AQL of 4.0 defects expressed in terms of defects per hundred units.

4.4.5 Examination of preparation for delivery. An examination shall be made to determine that packaging, packing, and marking comply with the section 5 requirements. Defects shall be scored in accordance with the list below. The sample unit shall be one shipping container fully prepared for inspection. The lot size shall be the number of shipping containers in the end item inspection lot. The inspection level shall be level S-2 and the AQL shall be 2.5 defects per hundred units.

Examine	Defect
Markings (exterior)	Omitted, incorrect, illegible; of improper size, location, sequence, or method of application
Materials	Any component missing, damaged, or not as specified
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components such as incomplete closure of polyethylene bag or container flaps
	Loose strapping or inadequate strapping
	Bulging or distortion of containers

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4.4.6 Examination of palletization. When required, an examination shall be made to determine that palletization is in compliance with section 5 of this specification. Defects shall be scored as specified in table V. The sample unit for this examination shall be one palletized unit load ready for shipment. The lot shall be the number of palletized unit loads submitted for inspection at one time. The inspection level shall be level S-1 with an AQL of 6.5 expressed in terms of defects per hundred units.

TABLE V. Examination of palletization

Examine	Defect
Finished dimension	Length, width, or height exceeds specified maximum requirement
Palletization	Pallet pattern not as specified Interlocking of loads not as specified Load not bonded with required straps specified
Weight	Exceeds maximum load limits
Marking	Omitted; incorrect; illegible; of improper size, location, sequence or method of application

4.5 Tests.

4.5.1 Coil compression. Coil compression shall be accomplished by placing the large end of a single coil on a flat surface and then compressing it manually, using a board or block over the top of the coil, until all adjacent convolutions are touching or are compressed to a height of not more than 2 inches. This procedure shall be repeated 20 times. Free coil height before and after testing shall be measured to determine conformity with the requirements specified in 3.3.1. If a large number of coils must be tested, a simple mechanical reciprocating device may be used to accomplish the above test. Any nonconformance shall constitute failure of this test.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Preservation and packaging. Preservation and packaging shall be level A or C as specified (see 6.2).

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5.1.1 Level A.

5.1.1.1 Bedsprings. Each bedspring shall be individually packaged in a snug-fitting 0.003-inch thick commercially available polyethylene bag. Prior to or during the closure of the bag by heat sealing, excess air within the bag shall be expelled.

5.1.1.2 Legs.

5.1.1.2.1 Preservation. All uncoated ferrous metal surfaces of each leg mounting bracket plate and wood screws shall be cleaned by process C-1, dried and coated with type P-9 preservative of MIL-P-116. Surfaces from which preservative might be removed by contact with packaging and packing materials shall be covered, wrapped or bagged with grease proof barrier material conforming to type I or II, grade A of MIL-B-121. Barrier material shall be secured with twine made of jute, sisal, manila or cotton, or with tape conforming to type III, grade A of PPP-T-45, or heat sealed when heat sealable barrier material is used.

5.1.1.2.2 Packaging. Six legs together with the mounting brackets and wood screws shall be packaged in a fiberboard box conforming to type CF (variety SW) or ST, class domestic, grade 175, style RSC of PPP-B-636. The finished wooden surfaces of each leg shall be wrapped with machine-glazed or highly calendered kraft paper or other non-abrasive cushioning material so to prevent scratching or marring during transit. The mounting brackets shall be secured onto each leg or shall be separated from contact with same by fiberboard inserts or other cushioning material. The wood screws shall be contained within a sealed paper or plastic envelope. Each box shall be closed in accordance with method II of the appendix of PPP-B-636.

5.1.2 Level C (commercial packaging). Bedsprings and legs shall be packaged to afford adequate protection against damage during shipment from the supply source to the first receiving activity. The package and quantity per package shall be the same as that normally used by the supplier for retail distribution.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B, or C, as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 Level A.

5.2.1.1 Bedspring. Each bedspring, packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a snug-fitting fiberboard shipping container conforming to grade V2s, style FOL (end opening) of PPP-B-636, except that the dimensional and weight limitations of the container specification shall be waived. Closure and reinforcing with strapping or tape banding shall be in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636.

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5.2.1.2 Legs. Legs, packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a snug-fitting fiberboard shipping container conforming to grade V2s, style RSC of PPP-B-636. Closure, waterproofing by means of tape, and reinforcing shall be in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636. The weight of contents of each shipping container shall not exceed 65 pounds.

5.2.2 Level B.

5.2.2.1 Bedspring. Each bedspring, packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed flat in a snug-fitting fiberboard shipping container conforming to type CF (variety SW) or SF, class domestic, grade 275, style FOL (end opening) or FTC of PPP-B-636, except that the dimensional and weight limitations of the container specification shall be waived, or class 1, style F of PPP-B-640. Closure shall be in accordance with method II of the appendix of the applicable box specification. The minimum reinforcement shall be two lengthwise and four girthwise straps with all other straps not less than 8 inches from the side and ends for FTC boxes and all the inner bands placed equidistant from the outer band.

5.2.2.2 Legs. Legs, packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a snug-fitting fiberboard shipping container conforming to type CF (variety SW) or SF, class domestic, grade 275, style RSC of PPP-B-636. Closure shall be in accordance with method II of the appendix of PPP-B-636. The weight of contents of each shipping container shall not exceed 65 pounds.

5.2.2.3 When specified (see 6.2), the shipping containers for bedsprings and legs shall be a grade V3c, V3s or V4s fiberboard box fabricated in accordance with PPP-B-636, and closed in accordance with the appendix thereto.

5.2.3 Level C (commercial packing). Bedsprings and legs, packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a manner to insure carrier acceptance and safe delivery at destination at the lowest transportation rate for such supplies. Containers and packing shall comply with Uniform Freight Classification Rules or National Motor Freight Classification Rules, as applicable.

5.3 Palletization. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2) legs packed as specified shall be palletized in accordance with load type I of MIL-STD-147. Each prepared load shall be bonded with primary and secondary straps in accordance with bonding means K and L. Pallet patterns shall be in accordance with the appendix of MIL-STD-147. Interlocking of loads shall be effected by reversing the pattern of each course. If the container is of a size which does not conform to any of the pallet patterns specified in MIL-STD-147, the pallet pattern used shall first be approved by the contracting officer.

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5.4 Marking.

5.4.1 Civil agencies. In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order, interior boxes and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with FED-STD-123.

5.4.2 Military agencies. In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order, interior boxes, shipping containers and palletized unit loads shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. Sizes 1, 2, 4, 5 and 6 bedsprings covered by this specification are intended for use with mattresses covered by V-M-96 as follows:

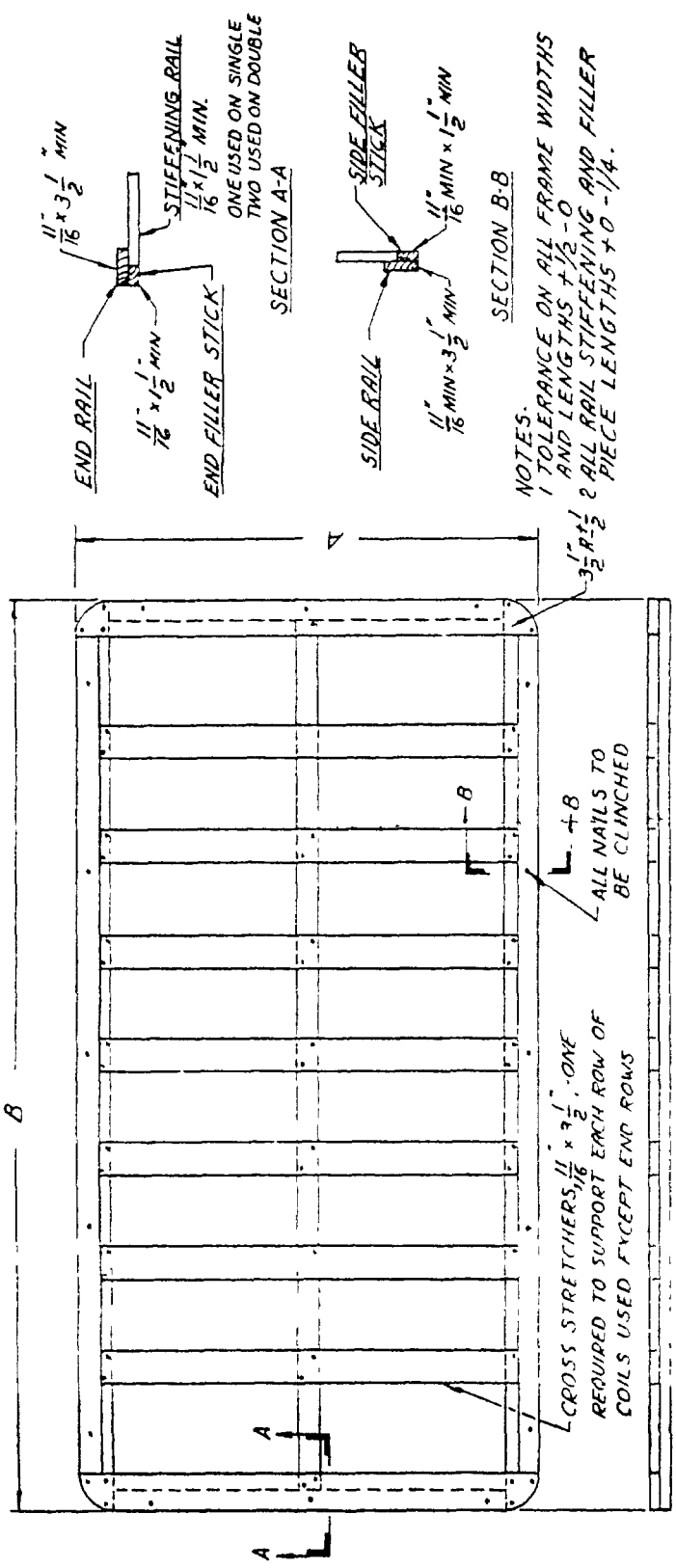
Bedspring size	Mattress size
Size 1	Size 7
Size 2	Size 12
Size 4	Size 14
Size 5	Size 15
Size 6	Size 15

Size 3 bedsprings are intended for special applications.

6.2 Ordering data. Purchasers should select the preferred options offered herein and include the following information in procurement documents.

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification
(b) Size required (see 1.2)
(c) First article. When first article sample is required (see 3.1, 4.2 and 6.4)
(d) When built-up frame is required for bedsprings intended for foam rubber mattresses (see 3.4.1)
(e) Additional marking as required (see 3.4.10)
(f) When legs are required (see 3.5)
(g) If other than a blond finish is required on legs (see 3.5)
(h) Selection of applicable levels of preservation and packaging (see 5.1 and 5.2)
(i) When weather-resistant fiberboard shipping containers are required for level B pack (see 5.2.2.3)
(j) When palletization of legs is required (see 5.3)

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SIZE	TYPE	D/M A	D/M B
1	SINGLE	37 1/2"	74"
2	DOUBLE	52 1/2"	74"
3	SINGLE (SPECIAL)	36"	78 1/2"
4	SINGLE (OVERSIZE)	37 1/2"	79"
5	DOUBLE (OVERSIZE)	52 1/2"	79
6	QUEEN	60"	80"

FIG 1 THIS FIGURE IS A MINIATURE COPY OF AN ARMY NATICK LABORATORIES DRAWING AND IS FOR INFORMATION ONLY; DRAWING REFERENCE IN PARAGRAPH 2.1 GOVERNS

FRAME, BEDSPRING, BOX TYPE; FOR SINGLE AND DOUBLE BEDS

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6.3 For civil agency use, level B packaging and packing should be used by ordering agencies only when shipment is known to be made to a holding supply depot or warehouse from which partial shipments will be made to ultimate consumers.

6.4 First article. When a first article is required, it shall be inspected and approved under the appropriate provisions of ASPR 7-104.55. The first article should be a preproduction sample, initial production item or other specific item described under the definition of a First Article in the ASPR. The contracting officer should specify the appropriate type of first article and the number of units to be furnished. The contracting officer should include specific instructions in all procurement instruments regarding arrangements for inspection and approval of the first article.

6.5 Size 5 is in the process of being phased out commercially and size 6 has been added as a possible replacement during this process.

Custodians:

Army - GL
Navy - YD
Air Force - 82

Review activities:

Army - MD

Preparing activity:

Army - GL

Civil Agency Coordinating Activities:

DC GOV'T - DCG
GSA-FSS
HEW - HSM
JUS-FPI
VA-DMS

Project No. 7210-0128

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

(See Instructions – Reverse Side)

1 DOCUMENT NUMBER	2 DOCUMENT TITLE

3a NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION	4 TYPE OF ORGANIZATION *(Mark one)*
	☐ VENDOR
b ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)*	☐ USER
	☐ MANUFACTURER
	☐ OTHER *(Specify)* _____

5 PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording

b. Recommended Wording

c. Reason/Rationale for Recommendation

6 REMARKS

7a. NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last, First, MI)* – Optional	b WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Area Code)* – Optional
c MAILING ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)* – Optional	8 DATE OF SUBMISSION *(YYMMDD)*

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